

Check — Unit Economics

Cheap to clear, expensive to handle

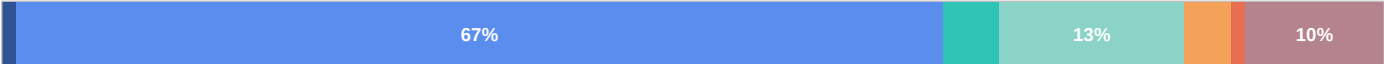
FULLY-LOADED COST PER TRANSACTION

\$2.980

Saves \$2.21 per txn if migrated to instant

Cost component	Detail	Amount	% of total
1. Network fee		\$0.030	1.0%
2. Processing / operations		\$2.000	67.1%
3. Failure & exception	1.5% return × \$8.00/item	\$0.120	4.0%
4. Fraud loss (expected)		\$0.400	13.4%
5. Fraud prevention / screening		\$0.100	3.4%
6. Compliance (AML / sanctions)		\$0.030	1.0%
7. Reconciliation		\$0.300	10.1%
8. Liquidity / prefunding		\$0.000	0.0%
TOTAL		\$2.980	100.0%

Cost composition (share of the fully-loaded cost)



What this means: A check costs almost nothing to **clear** — but the real cost is in **manual handling**: printing, postage, data entry, and reconciliation make up most of the \$2.98. This is the **#1 migration target**.

Sources: Network fees — Fed / Nacha / The Clearing House pricing. Failure rates — Nacha return thresholds (~1.5% typical); failed-payment cost ~\$12.10 (LexisNexis). Fraud — AFP Payments Fraud Survey; 2024 losses check ~\$24B, ACH ~\$11B, APP ~\$12.5B. Compliance — FFIEC / BSA-AML. Liquidity — RTP prefunded joint account (frbsservices.org). All figures are conservative public-benchmark midpoints, to be calibrated with Payfinia production data. See Deliverable 1.